

3.2 Descriptors of the Marking Scale

The marking scale is as follows: A1-A5; B1-B3; C1-C3; D1-D3, E1-E3; F1-F3; G1-G2, H

GRADE	BAND	SCORE	DESCRIPTOR
A	A1	22	College Descriptor Exemplary attainment of intended learning outcomes, secured by discriminating command of a comprehensive range of relevant materials and analyses, and by deployment of considered judgment relating to key issues, concepts and procedures. School of Law gloss on descriptor Answers at this level will show a very full knowledge and understanding of the material and of relevant interpretative and critical points. They will be well constructed with clear conclusions, supported by sound arguments. Answers will show some independence of thought. This may mean that the student has produced new arguments of his or her own, but is more likely to be a matter of making arguments from the literature 'one's own' by, for example, using one's own expression and organisation and one's own examples. Where relevant the student will show to a high degree the ability to apply legal principles to the solution of problems, and there will be good use of primary and secondary sources, and proper reference to authority.
	A2	21	
	A3	20	
	A4	19	
	A5	18	
B	B1	17	College Descriptor Conclusive attainment of most intended learning outcomes. Grounded in a familiarity with a range of supporting evidence, constructively utilized to reveal appreciable depth of understanding School of Law gloss on descriptor Answers at this level will show a full knowledge and understanding of the material and of relevant critical and interpretative points. They will be generally well constructed with clear conclusions supported by sound arguments. But the answers will generally show less independence of thought and mastery of detail than those in the A band. There may be some errors or misunderstandings in relatively unimportant details. Where relevant the student will show substantial ability to apply legal principles to the solution of problems. There will be substantial use of primary and secondary sources, and proper reference to authority.
	B2	16	
	B3	15	
C	C1	14	College Descriptor Clear attainment of most of the intended learning outcomes displaying sufficient familiarity with and sufficient analytical grasp of relevant materials. School of Law gloss on descriptor Answers will show a generally sound knowledge and understanding of the material and of relevant critical and interpretative points. Answers will be less clearly organised than those in the higher bands and there may be some significant errors, omissions or misunderstandings. Where relevant the student will show some ability to apply legal principles to the solution of problems. There should be some use of primary and secondary sources, and reference to authority.
	C2	13	
	C3	12	
D	D1	11	College Descriptor Partial attainment of intended learning outcomes. Mixed evidence as to depth of knowledge and competence in the deployment of arguments. School of Law gloss on descriptor Answers will show an adequate level of knowledge and understanding of the material, but they are likely to be lacking in detail and to include significant errors, omissions and misunderstandings. The grasp shown of critical and interpretative points may be insecure and the organisation of the answer may be weak. The student should show awareness of the need to refer to authority and limited ability to apply legal principles to the solution of problems.
	D2	10	
	D3	9	
E	E1	8	College Descriptor Deficient attainment of intended learning outcomes, with unconvincing evidence of depth of knowledge and weak deployment of
	E2	7	
	E3	6	

			arguments. School of Law gloss on descriptor Answers at this level will show knowledge and understanding of some of the relevant material but there will be serious deficiencies. Understanding of critical and interpretative points may be poor. The answer may be badly organised and difficult to follow. The student may be unable to apply legal principles to the solution of problems. The student may not show awareness of the need to refer to authority.
F	F1 F2 F3	5 4 3	College Descriptor Appreciably deficient attainment of intended learning outcomes, lacking secure basis in relevant factual and analytical dimensions. School of Law gloss on descriptor Answers at this level will show knowledge and understanding of very little of the relevant material. Understanding of critical and interpretative points will be poor. The answer may be badly organised and difficult to follow. The student may be unable to apply legal principles to the solution of problems. The student may not show awareness of the need to refer to authority.
G	G1 G2	2 1	College Descriptor Minimal attainment of intended learning outcomes. School of Law gloss on descriptor Answers at this level will show very serious weaknesses. Very little knowledge will be shown of the relevant material and what is known will have been seriously misunderstood. If there is any attempt at critical or interpretative discussion it will be inappropriate or badly confused. The student may be unable to apply legal principles to the solution of problems. The student may not show awareness of the need to refer to authority.
H		0	College Descriptor No attainment of learning outcomes.